

A hand of cards in a 5-card draw game. The hand consists of the Ace of Spades, King of Spades, Queen of Spades, Jack of Spades, and 10 of Spades. The community cards on the table are the 7 of Hearts, 5 of Hearts, 6 of Diamonds, 3 of Diamonds, and 2 of Diamonds. The pot is 100 chips.

Count Fast and Slow Losers				
				Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers			
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

A collection of playing cards. On the left, a Queen of Clubs is shown. Next to it is a 7 of Diamonds. To the right of that is a 10 of Spades. Further right is an Ace of Hearts. In the foreground, a fan of cards is displayed, starting with the Ace of Clubs and ending with the 3 of Hearts. The cards are arranged in a way that suggests a game or a hand being dealt.

Count Sure Winners				
				Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6♠

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 1NT

Declarer: East

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ -

♥ 10 9 6 3

♦ K Q J 9 4

♣ Q 10 9 7

♠ K Q 9 8 7 5 2

♥ A 2

♦ A 2

♣ 5 2



♠ 10 3

♥ K Q J 8 4

♦ 10 8 7 5

♣ J 8

♠ A J 6 4

♥ 7 5

♦ 6 3

♣ A K 6 4 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

1♠

Pass

1♣

Pass

4NT

Pass

2♠

Pass

6♠

5♥

All Pass

6♠ by North

North is to play 6♠. East leads the ♥K.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=1 ♦=1 ♣=0 Total = 2

One of the two red losers must be discarded on dummy's ♣ suit. So you pull trumps, taking two rounds, with ♠K and ♠Q. Then play two top ♣s and ruff a ♣. When East shows out on the third ♣, enter dummy with a trump and ruff another ♣. Dummy's final ♣ is now established, so enter dummy with another trump and discard one of the red losers on the fifth ♣.

As long as the ♣s were no worse than 4-2 you can establish the suit.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 9 7 2

♥ A J 6

♦ 7 5

♣ Q 6 4 3

♠ A 8

♥ Q 10 8 2

♦ Q J 9

♣ J 10 9 7



♠ Q J 5

♥ K 5 4 3

♦ A 4 3

♣ A K 5

♠ K 6 4 3

♥ 9 7

♦ K 10 8 6 2

♣ 8 2

West

North

East

South

1NT

All Pass

1NT by East

No, you must establish ♠s, the suit where they have 2 winners anyway. So you play a ♠ which South wins. He takes his 2 ♦s but you are now home free. When you gain the lead again you will get your ♠ winner established and only lose 2 ♠s and 4 ♦s.

If you finessed the ♥ you would have gone down with the defenders winning 4 ♦s, 1 ♥ and 2 ♠s.

If you had played 3 rounds of ♣s you would have gone down with the defenders winning 4 ♦s, 1 ♣ and 2 ♠s.

Only by establishing ♠s can you make the contract.

East is to play 1NT. South leads the ♦6, taken by North with the ♦J. North next plays the ♦Q on which South plays the ♦2. North plays the ♦9 which you finally win.

Winners: ♠=0 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=3 Total = 6

You only need one more winner and you have several possibilities. The ♥ finesse might work, or the ♣s might split 3-3. But you need to consider the defenders winners also. They have already scored 2 ♦ tricks and will get 2 more as soon as they gain the lead. (The spot cards told you that South has a 5-card ♦ suit.) Plus they have the 2 top ♠s which they can take whenever they like. So if your play sets up just one more trick for them you will go down.